Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300A
Children's Literature (I)
MIDTERM ASSESSMENT
MAIN- ALL BRANCHES
Makeup - KSA
2025-2026 / First Semester
Date: 18 Nov. 2025
12:00 – 2:00

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are TWO sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer two questions from Section 1, and One question from Section 2.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end with a conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Analyze and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

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SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS (10 marks)

Answer TWO of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1. **"In Perrault's *Cinderella*, the midnight deadline functions as more than a plot device." Examine its symbolic significance and psychological impact on both Cinderella and the reader. (5 marks)**
2. **Compare how Perault and Dahl's versions of Cinderella construct gender roles through Cinderella's character. (5 marks)**
3. **"In Dahl's 'Cinderella', the abrupt ending in which Cinderella marries a jam-maker challenges fairy-tale closure." Comment with reference to its implications. (5 marks)**

SECTION 2: ESSAY WRITING/ CLOSE READING (20 MARKS)

Answer EITHER Question 1 OR Question 2 in 250 WORDS.

Question 1: ESSAY WRITING

"In L. M. Alcott's *Little Women*, the overt moral instruction coexists with covert acts of resistance, creating narrative tension." Discuss with reference to both the primary text and secondary sources.

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Question 2: CLOSE READING

Analyse the following passage from L. M. Alcott's *Little Women* focusing on Jo's confession and the complexity of her emotional struggle with anger and guilt.

Mother, if she should die, it would be my fault.' And Jo dropped down beside the bed in a passion of penitent tears, telling all that had happened, bitterly condemning her hardness of heart, and sobbing out her gratitude for being spared the heavy punishment which might have come upon her. 'It's my dreadful temper! I try to cure it, I think I have, and then it breaks out worse than ever. Oh, Mother, what shall I do? What shall I do?' cried poor Jo, in despair. 'Watch and pray, dear, never get tired of trying, and never think it is impossible to conquer your fault,' said Mrs. March, drawing the blowzy head to her shoulder and kissing the wet cheek so tenderly that Jo cried even harder.

'You don't know, you can't guess how bad it is! It seems as if I could do anything when I'm in a passion. I get so savage, I could hurt anyone and enjoy it. I'm afraid I shall do something dreadful some day, and spoil my life, and make everybody hate me.

Oh, Mother, help me, do help me!' 'I will, my child, I will. Don't cry so bitterly, but remember this day, and resolve with all your soul that you will never know another like it.

Jo, dear, we all have our temptations, some far greater than yours, and it often takes us all our lives to conquer them. You think your temper is the worst in the world, but mine used to be just like it.' 'Yours, Mother? Why, you are never angry!' And for the moment Jo forgot remorse in surprise.

'I've been trying to cure it for forty years and have only succeeded in controlling it. I am angry nearly every day of my life, Jo, but I have learned not to show it, and I still hope to learn not to feel it, though it may take me another forty years to do so.'…

The knowledge that her mother had a fault like hers, and tried to mend it, made her own easier to bear and strengthened her resolution to cure it, though forty years seemed rather a long time to watch and pray to a girl of fifteen.

***Little Women*, (1868) p. 137-8**

End of Exam

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